

CEO

Isadora Quinn, Macro Oracle

CEO · EXECUTIVE



HIRE

◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Financials funding source.

Whenever a Rates, Market, or Inflation Stress Test resolves, gain 2 Surplus.

At the start of your turn, look at the top card of your deck. You may put it on the bottom.

Called the last three crises and eleven that never came, and bills for all fourteen.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 212 / 357

OFFICE LOCATION

Chicago

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 4 branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 3 Equity Futures, Commodity Futures, or Interest-Rate Futures treaties you control, combined (round down).

The weather is volatile, so the book is hedged.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 339 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 357

Private Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½ each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 357

Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Inflation ▼ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

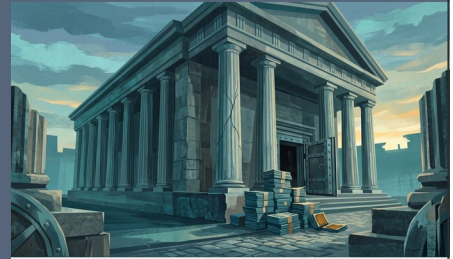
Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 051 / 357

Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Inflation ▼ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 051 / 357

Sports-Gambling Prediction Markets

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Whenever a Regulation, Market, or Geopolitical Stress Test resolves, gain 1 Surplus.

Even the local pub needs to hedge sometimes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 074 / 357

Crypto

STAPLE INVESTMENT



COST

◆ N + 1

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

N any time

STAPLE

▲ Low Interest Rates ▲ Short-Term Rates

Staple: any number per deck.

N is the total number of Crypto cards on all companies' boards, including NFT copies. Count before buying or selling.

HODL! (This is not financial advice.)

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 055 / 357

Short Sale

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Play only against a Market Stress Test. Gain 3 Surplus.

Schadenfreude: German for enjoying someone else's portfolio falling.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 122 / 357

Short Sale

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Play only against a Market Stress Test. Gain 3 Surplus.

Schadenfreude: German for enjoying someone else's portfolio falling.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 122 / 357

Market Data Terminal

DATA



PRICE

◆ 3

Your Market and Liquidity Surprise Inspections cost 1 less Leverage.

Thirty thousand dollars a year for a keyboard with colored keys, and the one chat room the whole market is in.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 344 / 357

Former Regulator

EXECUTIVE

DARK



HIRE

◆ 2

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to stop a Regulation Stress Test that hits you, unless the player who ran it pays 3 more Leverage.

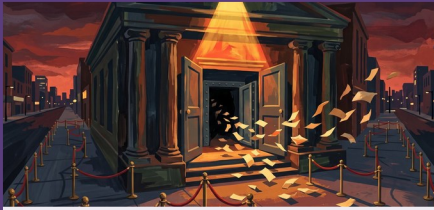
Wrote the rule and now bills by the hour to explain it.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 209 / 357

Bank Run

LIQUIDITY



COST

◆ 5

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 8 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure. Then they discard half their Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Junk Bonds, Private Credit Fund, or Feeder Fund it controls.

Deposits left in hours, not months.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 261 / 357

Trading Desk

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if a Market Stress Test hits you.

Buys low, sells high, and has a very good explanation for the other days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 080 / 357

Pod PM

FRONT LINE



HIRE

◆ 2

Requires a Financials funding source.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 5 of your loss from its Short-Term Equity or Long-Term Equity clauses. Then fire this employee.

Hits the drawdown limit, clears the desk by noon, has three offers by dinner.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 221 / 357

Pod PM

FRONT LINE



HIRE

◆ 2

Requires a Financials funding source.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 5 of your loss from its Short-Term Equity or Long-Term Equity clauses. Then fire this employee.

Hits the drawdown limit, clears the desk by noon, has three offers by dinner.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 221 / 357

Short Volatility Note

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

SIGNATURE

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Destroyed if a Market Stress Test hits you.

Nine years of smooth returns, collected one small premium at a time, until one Tuesday afternoon took them all back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 082 / 357

Contingent Convertibles

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

Destroyed if a Regulation Stress Test hits you.

The buyer read 'bond' where the regulator read 'equity,' and the prospectus had said so all along.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 083 / 357

Discount Tail Hedge

TREATY



COST

◆ 1

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

When a Market Stress Test would cost you more than 4 Surplus, prevent the rest.

Destroyed if Great Recession, Global Recession, or Flash Crash hits you.

Sold by a fund that has never missed a payment, having never been asked for one.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 151 / 357

Feed Tea Blockchain Co.

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 1

SALE

3 any time

DARK SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Signature: one copy per deck.

Destroyed if Short-Seller Report or Short and Distort hits you.

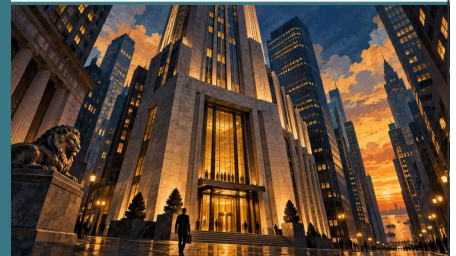
The same beverages under a new name, with a new press release and a new share price.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 084 / 357

New York

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 4 branch only

▲ Litigation

Headquarters or **Open** as a branch.

The first Investment you play on your turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

The deal closes before the lunch reservation does.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 333 / 357

INVESTMENT

INVESTMENT

VIX Calls

INVESTMENT

COST
◆ 2

SALE
1 any time

CARRYING COST
● 1 each turn

When a Stress Test with a Volatility clause hits you, gain 10% of the Surplus the whole table loses after protection and recovers. Add your long-vol payouts, then round down.

Calm markets cost you a little every month, until everyone else's bad day pays you back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 095 / 357

INVESTMENT

INVESTMENT

VIX Calls

INVESTMENT

COST
◆ 2

SALE
1 any time

CARRYING COST
● 1 each turn

When a Stress Test with a Volatility clause hits you, gain 10% of the Surplus the whole table loses after protection and recovers. Add your long-vol payouts, then round down.

Calm markets cost you a little every month, until everyone else's bad day pays you back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 095 / 357

PROGRAM

PROGRAM

Delta Hedging

TREATY

COST
◆ 0

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Short-Term Equity exposures counts as Volatility instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier programs choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

The risk did not leave so much as change desks.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 154 / 357

PROGRAM

PROGRAM

Delta Hedging

TREATY

COST
◆ 0

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Short-Term Equity exposures counts as Volatility instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier programs choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

The risk did not leave so much as change desks.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 154 / 357

SURPRISE INSPECTION

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Asset Freeze

GEOPOLITICAL

COST
◆ 3

HITS
Target opponent

Target opponent has one Investment to discard without Sale proceeds, chosen by the runner.

The position was marked at full value right up until the moment it could not be sold, moved, or mentioned.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 329 / 357

SURPRISE INSPECTION

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Margin Call

LIQUIDITY

COST
◆ 3

HITS
Target opponent

ESCALATE
▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 2 per Volatility exposure, and 2 per investment they control.

The broker would like a word, and also your cash.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 268 / 357

STRESS TEST

STRESS TEST

Quantitative Easing

RATES

HITS
Every company from the pile

ACT OF GOD
▲ Low Interest Rates

Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Low Interest Rates exposure.

The central bank was very clear about its plans, which was the problem.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 243 / 357

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Volcker Shock

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1979

HITS
Every company from the pile

SIGNATURE
▲ Short-Term Rates ▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Rates exposure, 2 per Liquidity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

In October 1979 the Federal Reserve let short-term rates climb toward 20% to break inflation, and the savings and loans that had funded 30-year mortgages with passbook savings never recovered.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 295 / 357

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

1973 Oil Crisis

INFLATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 1973

HITS
Every company from the pile

SIGNATURE
▲ Inflation ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Short-Term Rates

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Inflation exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 4 per Short-Term Rates exposure.

In October 1973, Arab oil producers cut off exports to the United States and other countries, quadrupling oil prices and setting off years of high inflation.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 254 / 357

Tariff Shock

MARKET



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Inflation ▲ Volatility

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure, 6 per Inflation exposure, and 3 per Volatility exposure.

Announced on Tuesday, paused on Wednesday, priced in by Thursday.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 253 / 357

Debt Ceiling Breach

MARKET



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE
▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Liquidity
▲ Short-Term Rates ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Rates exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Long-Term Treasuries it controls.

Everyone knew the date, which Congress treated as a suggestion.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 260 / 357

Flash Crash

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD
▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

On May 6, 2010, a burst of automated selling briefly wiped about a trillion dollars off the value of U.S. stocks. The Dow fell almost 1,000 points in minutes, then mostly came back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 276 / 357

Industry-Wide Probe

REGULATION



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Dark card in its discard pile.

The regulator sent the same letter to everyone, though some recipients are more nervous than others.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 294 / 357

AI Bubble Bursts

MARKET



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE
▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every AI card and every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

It was three laptops in a trench coat the whole time.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 257 / 357

LDI Crisis

LIQUIDITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE
▲ Liquidity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Liquidity exposure and 3 per Program it controls.

In September 2022, UK pension funds' interest-rate hedges called for collateral so fast that the central bank had to buy gilts to calm the market. The funds were hedged against everything except their hedges.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 301 / 357

Bird Flu Pandemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD
▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

Public health agencies have tracked the strain for years.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 234 / 357